



(12) **United States Plant Patent**
van Sambeek

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- (54) **PHLOX PLANT NAMED**
‘DOPHLOSPRIPIDAE’
- (50) Latin Name: *Phlox subulata*
Varietal Denomination: **Dophlosripidae**
- (71) Applicant: **DUMMEN GROUP B.V.**, De Lier
(NL)
- (72) Inventor: **Ellen van Sambeek**, Oegstgeest (NL)
- (73) Assignee: **Dümmen Group B.V.**, De Lier (NL)
- (*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this
patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.
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- (51) **Int. Cl.**
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A01H 6/70 (2018.01)
- (52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./320**
CPC *A01H 6/70* (2018.05)
- (58) **Field of Classification Search**
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See application file for complete search history.
- Primary Examiner — Keith O. Robinson
(74) Attorney, Agent, or Firm — C. Anne Whealy
- (57) **ABSTRACT**
A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named ‘Dophlos-
ripidae’, characterized by its outwardly spreading to creep-
ing and mounding plant habit; vigorous growth habit; freely
flowering habit; large pale purplish red-colored flowers with
deep purplish red-colored centers; and good garden perfor-
mance.
- 1 Drawing Sheet**

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Botanical designation: *Phlox subulata*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘DOPHLOSPRIPIDAE’.

STATEMENT REGARDING PRIOR
DISCLOSURES BY INVENTOR &
APPLICANT/ASSIGNEE

An European Community Plant Breeder’s Rights appli-
cation for the instant plant was filed by the Applicant/
Assignee, Dümmen Group B.V. of De Lier, The Netherlands
on Aug. 12, 2020, application number 2020/1900. Foreign
priority is not claimed to this application.

The Inventor and Applicant/Assignee assert that no pub-
lications nor advertisements relating to sales, offers for sale
or public distribution occurred more than one year prior to
the effective filing date of this application. Any information
about the claimed plant would have been obtained from a
direct or indirect disclosure from the Inventor and/or Appli-
cant/Assignee. Inventor and Applicant/Assignee claim a
prior art exemption under 35 U.S.C. 102(b)(1) for disclosure
and/or sales prior to the filing date but less than one year
prior to the effective filing date.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Phlox* plant, botanically known as *Phlox subulata* and
hereinafter referred to by the name ‘Dophlosripidae’.

The new *Phlox* plant is a product of a planned breeding
program conducted by the Inventor in Aalsmeer, The Neth-
erlands. The objective of the breeding program was to create
new freely-flowering *Phlox* plants with large attractive flow-
ers.

The new *Phlox* plant originated from a cross-pollination
made by the Inventor in April, 2013 in Aalsmeer, The
Netherlands, of a proprietary selection of *Phlox subulata*
identified as code number SB13-000002-002, not patented,

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as the female, or seed, parent with a proprietary selection of
Phlox subulata identified as code number SB-0097, not
patented, as the male, or pollen, parent. The new *Phlox* plant
was discovered and selected by the Inventor as a single
flowering plant from within the progeny of the stated
cross-pollination in a controlled environment in Aalsmeer,
The Netherlands in April, 2014.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Phlox* plant by vegeta-
tive cuttings in a controlled environment in Aalsmeer, The
Netherlands since June, 2014 has shown that the unique
features of this new *Phlox* plant are stable and reproduced
true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Phlox* have not been observed under all
possible combinations of environmental conditions and cul-
tural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with
variations in environmental conditions such as temperature
and light intensity without, however, any variance in geno-
type.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of ‘Dophlos-
ripidae’. These characteristics in combination distinguish
‘Dophlosripidae’ as a new and distinct *Phlox* plant:

1. Outwardly spreading to creeping and mounding plant
habit.
2. Vigorous growth habit.
3. Freely flowering habit.
4. Large pale purplish red-colored flowers with deep
purplish red-colored centers.
5. Good garden performance.

Plants of the new *Phlox* differ primarily from plants of the
female parent selection in flower color as plants of the new
Phlox have pale purplish red-colored flowers with deep
purplish red-colored centers whereas plants of the female
parent selection have blue-colored flowers.

Plants of the new *Phlox* differ primarily from plants of the male parent selection in flower color as plants of the new *Phlox* have pale purplish red-colored flowers with deep purplish red-colored centers whereas plants of the male parent selection have dark pink-colored flowers with dark pink-colored centers.

Plants of the new *Phlox* can be compared to plants of *Phlox subulata* 'Emerald Cushion Blue', not patented. In side-by-side comparisons, plants of the new *Phlox* and 'Emerald Cushion Blue' differ in the following characteristics:

1. Petal lobe apices of plants of the new *Phlox* are obtuse whereas petal lobe apices of plants of 'Emerald Cushion Blue' are emarginate.
2. Plants of the new *Phlox* and 'Emerald Cushion Blue' differ in flower color as plants of the new *Phlox* have pale purplish red-colored flowers with deep purplish red-colored centers whereas plants of 'Emerald Cushion Blue' have light blue-colored flowers.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPH

The accompanying colored photograph illustrates the overall appearance of the new *Phlox* plant showing the colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photograph may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the colors of the new *Phlox* plant.

The photograph comprises a side perspective view of typical flowering plant of 'Dophlospripidae' grown in a container.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photograph and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown during the late winter and early spring in 17-cm containers initially in a glass-covered greenhouse and finished in an outdoor nursery in Aalsmeer, The Netherlands and under cultural practices typical of commercial *Phlox* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures averaged 21° C. and night temperatures averaged 15° C. Plants were pinched one time two weeks after planting rooted young plants and plants were 48 weeks old when the photograph and the description were taken. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, Second Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used. Botanical classification: *Phlox subulata* 'Dophlospripidae'. Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox subulata* identified as code number SB13-000002-002, not patented.

Male, or pollen, parent.—Proprietary selection of *Phlox subulata* identified as code number SB-0097, not patented.

Propagation:

Type.—By vegetative cuttings.

Time to initiate roots, summer.—About 16 days at temperatures about 26° C.

Time to initiate roots, winter.—About three weeks at temperatures about 23° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.—About 24 days at temperatures about 23° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plant, winter.—About four weeks at temperatures about 18° C.

Root description.—Medium in thickness, fibrous; typically white to light yellow in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizer type and formulation, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Moderately freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Herbaceous perennial typically grown as a container and garden plant; outwardly spreading to creeping and mounding plant habit; vigorous growth habit and relatively slow growth rate.

Plant height.—About 15 cm.

Plant width (spread).—About 40 cm.

Lateral branches.—Branching habit: Freely branching habit with numerous primary and secondary lateral branches developing per plant. Length: About 20 cm. Internode length: About 1.5 cm. Strength: Strong. Aspect: About 10° from vertical to horizontal. Texture and luster: Pubescent; glossy. Color: Close to 145A; with development, close to 161C.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Opposite, decussate; simple; sessile.

Length.—About 2.2 cm.

Width.—About 3 mm.

Shape.—Lanceolate.

Apex.—Acuminate.

Base.—Cuneate.

Margin.—Entire, slightly ciliate.

Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces.—Smooth, glabrous; glossy.

Venation pattern.—Hyphodromous.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 146A. Fully expanded leaves, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 146A; venation, close to 146A.

Flower description:

Flower type and flowering habit.—Single rotate and salverform flowers arranged in terminal and lateral panicles; flowers face mostly upright to outwardly depending on position on inflorescence; freely flowering habit with about three open flowers per inflorescence and about 558 flowers developing per plant during the flowering season.

Fragrance.—Not detected.

Natural flowering season.—Plants begin flowering about 39 weeks after planting; plants flower in April and May in the garden in The Netherlands; flowers persistent.

Flower buds.—Height: About 1 cm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Shape: Elliptical. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Color: Close to 62A.

Inflorescence height.—About 11 cm.

Inflorescence diameter.—About 6 cm.

Flower diameter.—About 2.2 cm to 2.3 cm.

Flower depth.—About 1.2 cm.

Flower throat diameter.—About 2 mm.

Flower tube length.—About 8 mm.

Flower diameter, proximally.—About 2 mm.

Petals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single whorl; petals fused at the base into a narrow tube. Lobe length: About 1 cm. Lobe width: About 7 mm.

Lobe shape: Obovate. Lobe apex: Obtuse. Lobe margin: Entire; slightly undulate. Lobe texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Throat texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Tube texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; matte. Color: When opening, upper surface: Close to 65B; towards the throat, close to 61A. When opening, lower surface: Close to 65B. Fully opened, upper surface: Close to 65C; towards the throat, close to 61A; venation, close to 65A; color becoming closer to 65D with development. Fully opened, lower surface: Close to 65B; venation, close to 65A; color becoming closer to 65D with development. Throat: Close to 65C; venation, close to 65C. Tube: Close to 65A; venation, close to 65A.

Sepals.—Quantity per flower: Typically five in a single whorl, fused towards the base; calyx, tubular in shape. Length: About 6 mm. Width: About 1 mm. Shape: Narrowly deltoid, subulate. Apex: Acuminate. Margin: Entire. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Pubescent; glossy. Color: When opening and fully opened, upper surface: Close to 187A. When opening and fully opened, lower surface: Close to 141A.

Peduncles.—Length: About 5 cm. Diameter: About 1 mm. Strength: Moderately strong. Aspect: About 30° from lateral branch axis. Texture and luster: Pubescent; glossy. Color: Close to 145A.

Pedicels.—Length: About 1.1 cm. Diameter: About 1 mm. Strength: Flexible. Aspect: About 10° from peduncle axis. Texture and luster: Pubescent; glossy. Color: Close to 141C.

Reproductive organs.—Stamens: Quantity per flower: Typically five. Filament length: About 1 mm. Filament color: Close to 145D. Anther size: About 1 mm by 0.5 mm. Anther shape: Elliptical. Anther color: Close to 13A. Pollen amount: Abundant. Pollen color: Close to 17A. Pistils: Quantity per flower: One. Pistil length: About 1 cm. Stigma diameter: About 1 mm. Stigma shape: Cleft, three-parted. Stigma color: Close to 150B. Style length: About 7 mm. Style color: Close to 145D. Ovary color: Close to 140A.

Seeds and fruits.—To date, seed and fruit development have not been observed on plants of the new *Phlox*.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Phlox* have been observed to have good garden performance and to tolerate rain, wind, temperatures ranging from -35° C. to 35° C. and to be suitable for USDA Hardiness Zone 3.

Pathogen & pest resistance: To date, plants of the new *Phlox* have not been observed to be resistant to pathogens and pests common to *Phlox* plants.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Phlox* plant named 'Dophlospripidae' as illustrated and described.

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